



Tanzania



Area 364,900 sq miles
(945,087 sq km)
Population 46.2 million
Capital Dodoma
Currency Tanzanian shilling
Official languages English
and Kiswahili
Life expectancy 52 years

The United Republic of Tanzania was formed in 1964 after a merger between the mainland Tanganyika Republic and the island of Zanzibar. Tourism is an important source of revenue for Tanzania, and its biggest attraction is the wildlife-rich Serengeti National Park. Mount Kilimanjaro, Africa's highest mountain, is located here.

Mozambique



Area 300,496 sq miles
(801,590 sq km)
Population 23.9 million
Capital Maputo
Currency New metical
Official language Portuguese
Life expectancy 42 years

Located on the southeast African coast, Mozambique is divided by the Zambezi River. Following its independence from Portugal in 1975, Mozambique was affected by civil war for 17 years. A truce was declared in 1992, and Mozambique held its first multiparty elections in 1994.

Mauritius



Area 718 sq miles
(1,860 sq km)
Population 1.3 million
Capital Port Louis
Currency Mauritian rupee
Official language English
Life expectancy 73 years

The islands that make up Mauritius are in the Indian Ocean. The main island, from which the country takes its name, is of volcanic origin and surrounded by coral reefs. Mauritius has enjoyed considerable economic success following recent industrial developments and the expansion of tourism.



▲ MAASAI PEOPLE

The Maasai are seminomadic people who live mainly in Kenya and northern Tanzania. They still follow their age-old customs, and can be recognized by their distinctive bright clothing.

Seychelles



Area 176 sq miles
(455 sq km)
Population 90,024
Capital Victoria
Currency Seychelles rupee
Official languages French
Creole, English, and French
Life expectancy 72 years

The Republic of Seychelles is made up of 115 islands in the Indian Ocean. Formerly a UK colony and then under one-party rule for 14 years, Seychelles became a multiparty democracy in 1993. The islands are home to unique flora and fauna, such as the Seychelles giant tortoise.

Madagascar



Area 226,657 sq miles
(587,040 sq km)
Population 21.3 million
Capital Antananarivo
Currency Ariary
Official languages French,
Malagasy, and English
Life expectancy 59 years

Lying in the Indian Ocean, Madagascar is the world's fourth-largest island. After being a socialist nation for 18 years, Madagascar became a multiparty democracy in 1993. It has a wealth of unique wildlife and plants—animals such as lemurs are not found anywhere else in the world.

Malawi



Area 45,745 sq miles
(118,480 sq km)
Population 15.4 million
Capital Lilongwe
Currency Malawian kwacha
Official language English
Life expectancy 48 years

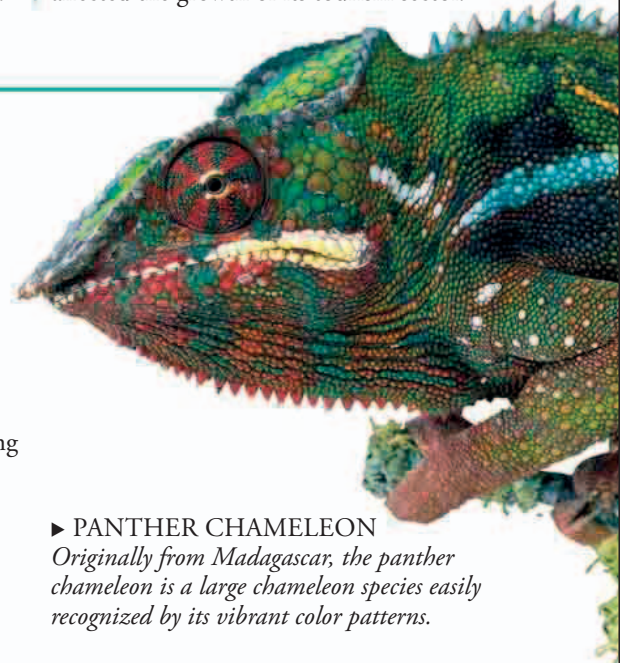
Landlocked in southeast Africa, Malawi lies on the Great Rift Valley and is dominated by Lake Malawi, Africa's third-largest lake. It gained independence from the UK in 1964 and was ruled by Hastings Banda for nearly three decades. It became a multiparty democracy in 1994. Malawi's major export earnings come from tobacco.

Comoros



Area 838 sq miles
(2,170 sq km)
Population 800,000
Capital Moroni
Currency Comoros franc
Official languages Arabic,
French, and Comoran
Life expectancy 63 years

The Union of the Comoros is an archipelago nation lying off the east African coast. It consists of three main islands and many islets. Since its independence from France in 1975, Comoros has faced many coups. The political instability has adversely affected the growth of its tourism sector.



► PANTHER CHAMELEON

Originally from Madagascar, the panther chameleon is a large chameleon species easily recognized by its vibrant color patterns.